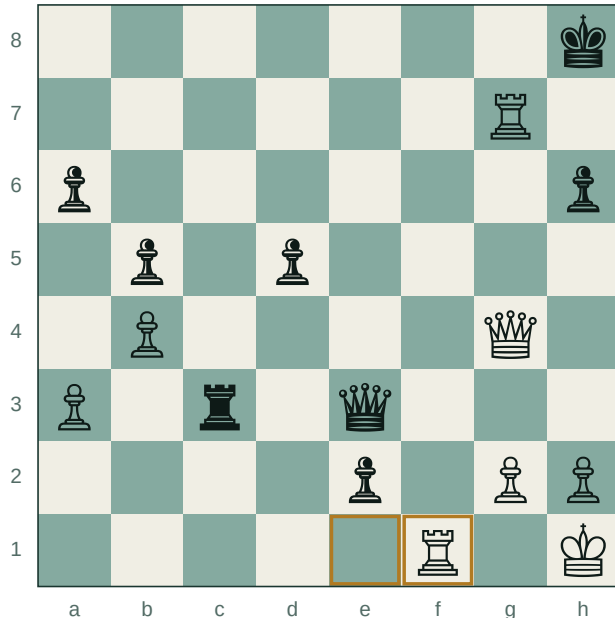


# Promotion combinations: Black, move 43

Promotion combinations

Black to move



Previous move: 43.Rxf1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**43...exf1=Q#**

**43...exf1=Q#** Mate: queen on f1 gives check; White has no legal reply. The pawn becomes a queen.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on f1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: rook on f1. Check for tactical protection.